

FAILURE OF BOUNDEDNESS FOR GENERALISED LOG CANONICAL SURFACES

CHRISTOPHER HACON AND XIAOWEI JIANG

ABSTRACT. In this paper, we construct counterexamples to the boundedness of generalised log canonical models of surfaces with fixed appropriate invariants, where the underlying varieties can have arbitrary Kodaira dimension. This answers a question of Birkar and the first author.

CONTENTS

1. Introduction	1
Acknowledgement	3
2. Preliminaries	3
2.1. Generalised pairs and singularities	3
2.2. Bounded family	4
2.3. Positivity of line bundles on the blow ups of surfaces	4
2.4. Artin's theorem on contractions	6
3. Proof of Theorem 1.3	6
4. Failure of boundedness for $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$	9
4.1. Calabi-Yau surfaces	9
4.2. Minimal surfaces of Kodaira dimension one	15
4.3. Minimal surfaces of general type	18
4.4. Weak Fano surfaces	21
References	24

1. INTRODUCTION

Throughout this paper, we work over an algebraically closed field k of characteristic zero.

According to the minimal model conjecture and the abundance conjecture, any variety Y with mild singularities is birational to a normal projective variety X such that either X admits a Mori fiber space $X \rightarrow Z$, or K_X is semiample. Classification of such X means

Date: August 19, 2026.

2020 Mathematics Subject Classification. 14A20, 14E30, 14J10, 14J17.

Key words and phrases. boundedness, generalised pairs, algebraic spaces.

construction of the corresponding moduli spaces. Usually, the first step to construct moduli spaces is to show that, after fixing certain invariants, our varieties belong to a bounded family.

When K_X is semiample, there exists a contraction $f : X \rightarrow Z$ to a normal variety Z . The canonical bundle formula

$$K_X \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} f^*(K_Z + B_Z + M_Z)$$

shows that the structure of $(Z, B_Z + M_Z)$ plays a fundamental role in understanding the geometry of X . We can then regard $(Z, B_Z + M_Z)$ as a *generalised pair* with ample $K_Z + B_Z + M_Z$, that is, a *generalised log canonical (lc) model*. We refer the reader to §2.1 for background on generalised pairs and their singularities. In this paper, we study the boundedness of generalised lc models. For the definition of boundedness for generalised pairs, see §2.2.

Definition 1.1. Fix $d \in \mathbb{N}$, $\Phi \subset \mathbb{Q}^{\geq 0}$ a DCC set, and $v \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. Let $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$ be the set of projective generalised pairs $(X, B + M)$ with data $X' \xrightarrow{\phi} X$ and M' where

- $(X, B + M)$ is generalised lc of dimension d ,
- the coefficients of B are in Φ ,
- $M' = \sum \mu_i M'_i$ where M'_i are nef Cartier and $\mu_i \in \Phi$,
- $K_X + B + M$ is ample, and
- $\text{vol}(K_X + B + M) = v$.

When $M = 0$, that is, when (X, B) is a usual pair, $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$ forms a bounded family by [HMX13, HMX14, HMX18], which is crucial for the construction of moduli spaces of varieties of general type [Kol23].

When $(X, B + M)$ is generalised klt, boundedness is known by [Bir21a] and has applications to studying the (birational) boundedness and moduli of klt good minimal models [Jia23, Zhu25, JJZ25, Jia25].

Although $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$ is log birationally bounded by [Bir21a, Proposition 5.2], Birkar and the first author construct an unexpected counterexample to its boundedness for $d \geq 3$, see [BH22, §5.3]. Nevertheless, the generalised pairs given by the canonical bundle formula are bounded under certain conditions [BH22, Theorem 1.3], which plays a key role in the study of boundedness and moduli of slc good minimal models [Bir22].

It is clear that $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(1, \Phi, v)$ forms a bounded family, and it is natural to ask whether $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ is bounded or not [BH22, Question 5.1]. In [Fil18], Filipazzi shows that $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ is bounded under the assumption that the Cartier index of M (rather than that of M') is bounded. However, as shown in [BH22, §5.2], the Cartier index of M is not bounded in general, even when the ambient variety X is fixed. In this paper, we will construct examples showing that $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ is not bounded in general, where $X \in \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ can have arbitrary Kodaira dimension.

Theorem 1.2. *Fix $\kappa \in \{-\infty, 0, 1, 2\}$. Let $\mathcal{P}_\kappa \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ be the subset of generalised pairs such that $\kappa(X) = \kappa$ for every $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{P}_\kappa$. Then $\mathcal{P}_\kappa$ is not bounded.*

In [BH22], Birkar and the first author construct a set of generalised pairs $(X, B + M)$ in $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(3, \Phi, v)$ such that each X is an lc Fano variety and the Cartier index of K_X is unbounded. However, after a flip, X becomes klt and bounded, while the failure of boundedness in dimension two implies that we cannot expect $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$ to be bounded in codimension one. On the other hand, for generalised lc surfaces $(X, B + M)$ in $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$, it can be shown that the Cartier index of K_X is bounded. Furthermore, if X is an lc Fano surface, then X belongs to a bounded family. We also prove the boundedness of $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ under additional assumptions.

Theorem 1.3. *Let $\mathcal{Q} \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ be a subset of generalised pairs. Then $\mathcal{Q}$ is bounded if one of the following holds for every $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{Q}$:*

- (1) X has only rational singularities,
- (2) $X \rightarrow Z$ is a minimal ruled fibration onto a nonsingular curve Z ,
- (3) $-K_X$ is ample,
- (4) K_X is ample.

By *minimal ruled fibration*, we mean a fibration whose general fiber is a nonsingular rational curve, with no exceptional curves of the first kind contained in any fiber. While boundedness in the Fano case fails in dimension three by [BH22], boundedness in the canonically polarized case holds in any dimension, see Corollary 3.2.

Acknowledgement. This work was done when the second author visited the first author at the University of Utah. The second author would like to thank the University of Utah for its hospitality. He also thanks his advisor Caucher Birkar for constant support and encouragement, and Qingyuan Xue for helpful comments. The first author was partially supported by NSF research grants no: DMS-2301374 and by a grant from the Simons Foundation SFI-MPS-MOV-00006719-07. We would like to thank the referee for a careful reading of this paper and for some very helpful comments.

2. PRELIMINARIES

2.1. Generalised pairs and singularities. We refer reader to [Bir21b] for a survey of generalised pairs. A *generalised pair* (X, B, M) consists of

- a normal variety X ,
- an effective $\mathbb{R}$ -divisor B on X , and
- a b- $\mathbb{R}$ -Cartier b-divisor M over X , represented by a projective birational morphism $f : X' \rightarrow X$ and an $\mathbb{R}$ -Cartier $\mathbb{R}$ -divisor M' on X' such that M' is nef and $K_X + B + M$ is $\mathbb{R}$ -Cartier, where $M := f_* M'$.

We will often refer to such a generalised pair by saying that $(X, B + M)$ is a generalised pair with data $X' \rightarrow X$ and M' .

Let D be a prime divisor over X . Replace X' with a log resolution of (X, B) such that D is a prime divisor on X' . We can write

$$K_{X'} + B' + M' = f^*(K_X + B + M).$$

We define the *generalised log discrepancy* of D to be $a(D, X, B, M) = 1 - \text{mult}_D B'$.

We say that $(X, B + M)$ is *generalised klt* (resp. *generalised lc*) if $a(D, X, B, M) > 0$ (resp. $a(D, X, B, M) \geq 0$) for every prime divisor D over X .

Remark 2.1. If $(X, B + M)$ is a generalised log canonical surface, then the negativity lemma [KM98, Lemma 3.39] applied to M' and the numerical pullback of M implies that (X, B) is numerically log canonical. Thus, (X, B) is log canonical by [Fuj12, Proposition 3.5], and M is $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier. Moreover, by [Fil18, Remark 3.6], M is nef. Similarly, we can show that X is log canonical.

2.2. Bounded family. A *couple* (X, D) consists of a normal projective variety X and a reduced divisor D on X . We do not assume that $K_X + D$ is $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier or that (X, D) has nice singularities.

A set $\mathcal{P}$ of generalised pairs is said to be a *bounded family* if there is a fixed $r \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for any $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{P}$, we can find a very ample divisor A on X satisfying

$$A^{\dim X} \leq r \quad \text{and} \quad A^{\dim X - 1} \cdot (K_X + B + M) \leq r.$$

The first condition implies that the underlying variety X is bounded. If the coefficients of B belong to a DCC set Φ , then the above conditions imply that $(X, \text{Supp } B)$ belongs to a *log bounded family of couples*. This is equivalent to saying that there is a quasi-projective scheme $\mathcal{X}$, a reduced divisor $\mathcal{E}$ on $\mathcal{X}$, and a projective morphism $h : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow T$, where T is of finite type and $\mathcal{E}$ does not contain any fiber, such that for every $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{P}$, there is a closed point $t \in T$ and an isomorphism $f : \mathcal{X}_t \rightarrow X$ such that $\mathcal{E}_t$ contains the support of $f_*^{-1}B$.

However, since M is not necessarily effective, we cannot control $\text{Supp } M$. In practice, we can only bound the intersection number $A^{\dim X - 1} \cdot M$.

2.3. Positivity of line bundles on the blow ups of surfaces. Firstly, we recall some results on ampleness and very ampleness for blow ups of $\mathbb{P}^2$.

Theorem 2.2 ([Bia89, Theorem 2.4]). *Let $Y \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$ be the blow up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ at r distinct points $p_1, \dots, p_r$ with exceptional divisors $E_1, \dots, E_r$. Let H denote the pull-back of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1)$. For $d, m_1, \dots, m_r \in \mathbb{Z}^{>0}$, let $L = dH - \sum_{i=1}^r m_i E_i$ be a line bundle on Y . If*

$$d \geq 1 + \sum_{i=1}^r m_i,$$

then L is very ample.

The bound is sharp and can be improved only if not all points $p_1, \dots, p_r$ lie on a line. If $d < 1 + \sum_{i=1}^r m_i$, determining whether L is very ample requires studying the positions of the points $p_1, \dots, p_r$.

Theorem 2.3 ([Han17, Theorem 2.1]). *Let $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be an irreducible and reduced curve of degree e . Let $Y \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$ be the blow up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ at r distinct smooth points $p_1, \dots, p_r \in C$ with exceptional divisors $E_1, \dots, E_r$. Let H denote the pull-back of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1)$. For $d, m_1, \dots, m_r \in \mathbb{Z}^{>0}$, let $L = dH - \sum_{i=1}^r m_i E_i$ be a line bundle on Y . Let F denote the proper transform of C on Y . If*

$$L \cdot F = ed - \sum_{i=1}^r m_i > 0$$

and

$$d > m_{i_1} + \dots + m_{i_e}$$

for any e distinct indices $i_1, \dots, i_e \in \{1, \dots, r\}$, then L is ample.

Theorem 2.4 ([Han17, Theorem 3.6]). *Let $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be an irreducible and reduced curve of degree e . Let $Y \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$ be the blow up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ at r distinct smooth points $p_1, \dots, p_r \in C$ with exceptional divisors $E_1, \dots, E_r$. Let H denote the pull-back of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1)$. For $d, m \in \mathbb{Z}^{>0}$, let $L = dH - m \sum_{i=1}^r E_i$ be a line bundle on Y . If*

$$(d+3)e > r(m+1) \quad \text{and} \quad r \geq e^2 + 2,$$

then L is very ample.

We also need the following result on the very ampleness of blow ups of ruled surfaces at arbitrary points.

Theorem 2.5 ([Bia90, Theorem 1.3]). *Let W be a ruled surface with invariant $d \geq 0$ over a curve C of genus g , with a fiber F and a section C^- satisfying $(C^-)^2 = -d$. Let $Y \rightarrow W$ be the blow up of W at r distinct points $p_1, \dots, p_r$ with exceptional divisors $E_1, \dots, E_r$. For simplicity, we still denote by C^- and F the divisors on Y given by the pullbacks of the divisors C^- and F on W , with no confusion. For $a, b, m_1, \dots, m_r \in \mathbb{Z}^{>0}$, let*

$$L = aC^- + bF - \sum_{i=1}^r m_i E_i$$

be a line bundle on Y . If

$$b \geq ad + 2g + 1 + \sum_{i=1}^r m_i,$$

and for any effective curve $C' = F - \sum_{i=1}^r \alpha_i E_i$ with $0 \leq \alpha_i \leq 1$, we have

$$L \cdot C' = a - \sum_i \alpha_i m_i \geq 1,$$

then L is very ample.

2.4. Artin's theorem on contractions.

Theorem 2.6 ([Art70, Corollary 6.10]). *Let X' be an algebraic space and $Y' \subset X'$ a closed subspace such that $I' = \mathcal{I}(Y')$ is locally principal, for instance assume that X', Y' are regular and of dimensions $d, d-1$, respectively. Let $f_0 : Y' \rightarrow Y$ be a proper map. Suppose that*

(1) *For every coherent sheaf F on Y' , if $n \gg 0$, then*

$$R^1 f_{0*}(F \otimes (I'/I'^2)^{\otimes n}) = 0.$$

(2) *For every $n \geq 1$, the canonical map*

$$f_{0*}(\mathcal{O}_{X'}/I'^n) \otimes_{f_{0*}\mathcal{O}_{Y'}} \mathcal{O}_Y \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_Y$$

is surjective.

Then there is a modification $f : X' \rightarrow X$, $Y \subset X$ whose set-theoretic restriction to Y is f_0 .

By *modification*, we mean a pair consisting of a proper map $f : X' \rightarrow X$ of algebraic spaces and a closed subset $Y \subset X$, such that the restriction of f to $U := X \setminus Y$ is an isomorphism. We may also refer to the pair as a *contraction* of X' , or as a *dilatation* of X , respectively.

Note that condition (2) is automatic if $R^1 f_{0*}(I'/I'^2)^{\otimes n} = 0$ for every $n \geq 1$.

3. PROOF OF THEOREM 1.3

In this section, we will prove the boundedness of $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ under additional assumptions.

We first recall the birational boundedness of $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$.

Theorem 3.1 ([Bir21a, Proposition 5.2]). *Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$, $\Phi \subset \mathbb{Q}^{\geq 0}$ be a DCC set, and $v \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. Then there exists a bounded set of couples $\mathcal{P}$ such that for each*

$$(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{F}_{glc}(d, \Phi, v)$$

with data $X' \xrightarrow{\phi} X$ and $M' = \sum \mu_i M'_i$, there is a log smooth couple $(\overline{X}, \overline{\Sigma}) \in \mathcal{P}$ and a birational map $\overline{X} \dashrightarrow X$ such that

- $\overline{\Sigma} \geq \overline{B}$, where $\overline{B}$ is the sum of the reduced exceptional divisors of $\pi : \overline{X} \dashrightarrow X$ plus the birational transform of B ,
- each M'_i descends to $\overline{X}$, say as $\overline{M}_i$, and
- letting $\overline{M} = \sum \mu_i \overline{M}_i$, we have

$$\text{vol}(K_{\overline{X}} + \overline{B} + \overline{M}) = v.$$

We can assume that $\psi : X' \dashrightarrow \overline{X}$ is a morphism. Since $K_X + B + M$ is ample,

$$\phi^*(K_X + B + M) \leq \psi^*(K_{\overline{X}} + \overline{B} + \overline{M}).$$

Moreover, $\text{vol}(K_{\overline{X}} + \overline{B} + \overline{M}) = \text{vol}(K_X + B + M)$. Thus, by [Bir21a, Lemma 2.17], $X \dashrightarrow \overline{X}$ does not contract any divisor, and $(X, B + M)$ is the generalised log canonical model of $(\overline{X}, \overline{B} + \overline{M})$.

Corollary 3.2. *Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$, $\Phi \subset \mathbb{Q}^{\geq 0}$ be a DCC set, and $v \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. For each*

$$(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{F}_{\text{glc}}(d, \Phi, v),$$

assume that K_X is pseudo-effective and that the MMP and Abundance conjectures hold. Let Z be the log canonical model of X . Then Z belongs to a bounded family. Moreover, if K_X is ample, then the generalised pair $(X, B + M)$ is bounded.

Proof. Let $(\overline{X}, \overline{\Sigma})$ be the birationally bounded model of $(X, B + M)$ given in Theorem 3.1, and let $\overline{E} \subset \overline{\Sigma}$ be the sum of the reduced exceptional divisors of the birational map $\pi : \overline{X} \dashrightarrow X$. If K_X is pseudo-effective, then since the rational map $\pi^{-1} : X \dashrightarrow \overline{X}$ does not contract any divisor, the variety Z is also the log canonical model of the pair $(\overline{X}, \overline{E})$. Moreover, since $(\overline{X}, \overline{E})$ is log smooth and belongs to a bounded family, its log canonical model also belongs to a bounded family, by [HMX18, Theorem 1.2].

If K_X is ample, then X belongs to a bounded family by the previous paragraph. Therefore, there exists a positive integer $l \in \mathbb{N}$ depending only on (d, Φ, v) such that lK_X is very ample. Then we have

$$(lK_X)^d = l^d \text{vol}(K_X) \leq l^d \text{vol}(K_X + B + M) = l^d v.$$

Since both K_X and $K_X + B + M$ are ample, it is easy to see that

$$(lK_X)^{d-1} \cdot (K_X + B + M) \leq l^{d-1} (K_X + B + M)^d = l^{d-1} v.$$

Hence, the generalised pair $(X, B + M)$ is bounded. □

Proof of Theorem 1.3. We use the notation in Theorem 3.1. Since $\pi^{-1} : X \dashrightarrow \overline{X}$ is a map of surfaces that does not contract any divisors, the map $\overline{X} \dashrightarrow X$ is a morphism.

(1). We aim to show that the Cartier index of M is bounded, and hence $(X, B + M)$ is bounded by [Fil18, Theorem 1.14].

By Step 4 of [Bir21a, Proof of Theorem 1.5, p.44], the coefficients of B and the μ_i all belong to a fixed finite set depending only on $(2, \Phi, v)$. By Step 4 of [Bir21a, Proof of Theorem 1.3, p.35], there is a log smooth couple $(\overline{\mathcal{X}}, \overline{\Omega})$ and a log smooth projective morphism $(\overline{\mathcal{X}}, \overline{\Omega}) \rightarrow T$ onto a smooth variety such that for each $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{F}_{\text{glc}}(2, \Phi, v)$, there is a closed point $t \in T$ so that $(\overline{X}, \overline{\Sigma}) \simeq (\overline{\mathcal{X}}_t, \overline{\Omega}_t)$. Moreover, for each i , there exist

irreducible components $\overline{\mathcal{G}}_i, \overline{\mathcal{F}}_i$ of $\overline{\Omega}$ such that

$$\overline{\mathcal{F}}_{i,t} - \overline{\mathcal{G}}_{i,t} \sim n\overline{\mathcal{M}}_i$$

for some $n \in \mathbb{N}$ depending only on $d = 2$. Therefore, there exist Cartier divisors $n\overline{\mathcal{M}}_i$ on $\overline{\mathcal{X}}$ such that $n\overline{\mathcal{M}}_{i,t} \sim n\overline{\mathcal{M}}_i$ for each i . Let $\overline{\mathcal{M}} := \sum \mu_i \overline{\mathcal{M}}_i$, then $\text{Supp}(\overline{\mathcal{M}}) \subset \overline{\Omega}$. Since μ_i belongs to a finite set, after replacing n by a bounded multiple, $n\overline{\mathcal{M}}$ is Cartier and $n\overline{\mathcal{M}}_t \sim n\overline{\mathcal{M}}$.

We now follow the idea in Step 5 of [Fil18, Proof of Theorem 1.14, p.845]. For each $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ and the birational morphism $\pi : \overline{X} \rightarrow X$, we can write

$$\pi^*M = \overline{M} + \sum b_j E_j,$$

where $E = \sum_j E_j$ is the π -exceptional divisor. Since $\overline{M}$ and the exceptional divisors of $\pi : \overline{X} \rightarrow X$ deform in the family, and the numerical pullback is computed intersection-theoretically, it follows from the negative definiteness of intersection matrix $(E_j \cdot E_k)_{jk}$ that the system of linear equations

$$(\overline{M} + \sum_j b_j E_j) \cdot E_k = 0 \quad \text{for all } k$$

has a unique solution depending only on $(2, \Phi, v)$. Therefore, there exists a divisor

$$\overline{\Phi} \leq \overline{\Omega} + \overline{\mathcal{M}},$$

supported on $\overline{\Omega}$, such that $\pi^*M = \overline{\Phi}_t$. Let l be a positive integer depending only on $(2, \Phi, v)$ such that $l\overline{\Phi}$ is integral.

Since X has only rational singularities, by [KM98, Lemma 4.13], $l\overline{\Phi}_t \sim 0$ in an analytic neighborhood of any π -exceptional curve. Thus, $\pi_* \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_t}(l\overline{\Phi}_t)$ is locally free in an analytic neighborhood of any closed point $x \in X$. Then, lM is Cartier at $\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x}$ for every closed point $x \in X$. Therefore, lM is Cartier by [BdFFU15, Lemma 5.12].

(2). If $X \rightarrow Z$ is a minimal ruled fibration onto a nonsingular curve Z , then X has only rational singularities by [Sak85, Lemma 4.6]. It follows from (1) that $(X, B + M)$ is bounded.

(3). Since the exceptional divisors of $\pi : \overline{X} \rightarrow X$ belong to a bounded family, the dual graphs of the π -exceptional curves and the corresponding weights are determined. By [KM98, Remark 4.9], the analytic isomorphism type of the germ $x \in X$ is determined by the dual graph. Therefore, the Cartier index of $-K_X$ is bounded. Then, by the effective base point free theorem [Fuj09, Theorem 1.1] and the very ampleness lemma [Fuj17, Lemma 7.1] for lc pairs, we can find $l \in \mathbb{N}$ depending only on $(2, \Phi, v)$ such that $-lK_X$ is very ample.

For each $(X, B + M) \in \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ and the birational morphism $\pi : \bar{X} \rightarrow X$, we can write

$$\pi^* K_X = K_{\bar{X}} + \sum a_j E_j$$

and

$$\pi^*(K_X + B + M) = K_{\bar{X}} + \pi_*^{-1} B + \bar{M} + \sum c_j E_j,$$

where E_j are the π -exceptional divisors. Moreover, we have

$$(K_{\bar{X}} + \sum a_j E_j) \cdot E_k = 0$$

and

$$(K_{\bar{X}} + \pi_*^{-1} B + \bar{M} + \sum c_j E_j) \cdot E_k = 0$$

for all k . By the same proof as in (1), the coefficients a_j and c_j are determined by $(2, \Phi, v)$. Since $\pi_*^{-1} B$, M , and the exceptional divisors of the birational morphism $\pi : \bar{X} \rightarrow X$ deform in the family, it follows that

$$(-K_X)^2 = (-\pi^* K_X)^2$$

and

$$(-K_X) \cdot (K_X + B + M) = \pi^*(-K_X) \cdot \pi^*(K_X + B + M)$$

are bounded. Hence, $(X, B + M)$ belongs to a bounded family.

(4). It follows from Corollary 3.2. Alternatively, to bound $(X, B + M)$, we can bound the Cartier index of K_X and the intersection numbers

$$K_X^2 \quad \text{and} \quad K_X \cdot (K_X + B + M)$$

by the same argument as in (3). □

4. FAILURE OF BOUNDEDNESS FOR $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$

In this section, we construct counterexamples to the boundedness of $\mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$, where the underlying varieties X can have arbitrary Kodaira dimension. Since boundedness holds when X has only rational singularities by Theorem 1.3, in our examples, X has elliptic singularities.

4.1. Calabi-Yau surfaces. In this subsection, we construct an unbounded set of generalised pairs $(X_i, B_i + M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_0 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ for $\Phi = \{0, 1\}$ and $v = 22$, such that $K_{X_i} \sim 0$, $B_i = 0$, and M_i is an ample Weil divisor with an unbounded Cartier index.

Let $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be a smooth elliptic curve, and let $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,11} \in C$ be distinct points such that for each $1 \leq j \leq 11$, the divisor $p_{i,j} - p_0 \in \text{Pic}^0(C)$ has order $n_{i,j}$, where p_0 is the identity element of the group structure on C . Let n_i be the order of the divisor $\sum_{j=1}^{11} (p_0 - p_{i,j})$. We may fix the points $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,10}$ and vary $p_{i,11}$ so that $n_{i,j}$ is independent of i for $1 \leq j \leq 10$, and both $n_{i,11}$ and n_i tend to infinity as $i \rightarrow \infty$.

Let $f_i : Y_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$ be the blow up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ at $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,11}$, and let $E_{i,1}, \dots, E_{i,11}$ be the exceptional divisors over $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,11}$, respectively. Let F_i denote the birational transform of C on Y_i . Write $E_i = \sum_{j=1}^{11} E_{i,j}$, then we have

$$K_{Y_i} = f_i^* K_{\mathbb{P}^2} + E_i \quad \text{and} \quad F_i + E_i = f_i^* C,$$

hence we have

$$K_{Y_i} + F_i = f_i^*(K_{\mathbb{P}^2} + C) \sim 0.$$

Let $H_i = f_i^* \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1)$ and $A_i = 5H_i - E_i$, then by Theorem 2.4, A_i is very ample on Y_i . We have

$$\text{vol}(A_i) = A_i^2 = 25 - 11 = 14.$$

Hence, Y_i belongs to a bounded family.

Since $F_i \sim 3H_i - E_i$, an easy computation shows that $(A_i + 2F_i) \cdot F_i = 0$. Let $\widetilde{p_{i,j}}$ be the points on F_i lying over $p_{i,j}$ for $1 \leq j \leq 11$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} (A_i + 2F_i)|_{F_i} &= (11H_i - 3E_i)|_{F_i} \\ &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(11))|_{F_i} \otimes \mathcal{O}_{F_i}(-\sum_{j=1}^{11} \widetilde{p_{i,j}})^{\otimes 3} \\ &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(11)|_C \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(-\sum_{j=1}^{11} p_{i,j})^{\otimes 3}) \\ &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_C(\sum_{j=1}^{11} (p_0 - p_{i,j}))^{\otimes 3}). \end{aligned}$$

Let m_i be the order of $(A_i + 2F_i)|_{F_i} \in \text{Pic}^0(F_i)$ so that $\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i(A_i + 2F_i)) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{F_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{F_i}$. Then we have $m_i = n_i$ if $3 \nmid n_i$, and $m_i = \frac{n_i}{3}$ if $3 \mid n_i$.

Lemma 4.1. *The linear system $|m_i(A_i + 2F_i)|$ is big and base point free on Y_i , and it defines a contraction $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ to a projective Calabi-Yau surface, which contracts F_i to a simple elliptic singularity.*

Proof. Since A_i is ample and F_i is effective, $A_i + 2F_i$ is big. Moreover, we have $(A_i + 2F_i) \cdot F'_i \geq 1$ for any irreducible curve $F'_i \neq F_i$, and $(A_i + 2F_i) \cdot F_i = 0$. Hence, $A_i + 2F_i$ is nef. We aim to show $|m_i(A_i + 2F_i)|$ is base point free.

We first claim that the restriction map $\text{Pic}(2F_i) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(F_i)$ is an isomorphism, which implies

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i(A_i + 2F_i)) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{2F_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{2F_i}.$$

Indeed, the short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(-F_i) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{F_i} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{2F_i}^* \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{F_i}^* \rightarrow 0$$

induces a long exact sequence

$$H^1(F_i, \mathcal{O}_{F_i}(-F_i|_{F_i})) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(2F_i) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(F_i) \rightarrow 0.$$

Since $-F_i^2 = 2$, we have $H^1(F_i, \mathcal{O}_{F_i}(-F_i|_{F_i})) = 0$, which yields the desired isomorphism.

Since $\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i(A_i + 2F_i)) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{2F_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{2F_i}$, we have the short exact sequence

$$(4.1) \quad 0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i A_i + (2m_i - 2)F_i) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i(A_i + 2F_i)) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{2F_i} \rightarrow 0.$$

By Theorem 2.3, the divisor

$$m_i A_i + (2m_i - 1)F_i \sim (11m_i - 3)H_i - (3m_i - 1)E_i$$

is ample. Hence, Kodaira vanishing gives

$$H^1(Y_i, m_i A_i + (2m_i - 2)F_i) = H^1(Y_i, K_{Y_i} + m_i A_i + (2m_i - 1)F_i) = 0.$$

Therefore, the map

$$H^0(Y_i, m_i(A_i + 2F_i)) \rightarrow H^0(\mathcal{O}_{2F_i})$$

induced by the exact sequence (4.1) is surjective.

Thus, there exists a divisor in the linear system $|m_i(A_i + 2F_i)|$ that does not intersect any point of $F_i = \text{Supp}(2F_i)$. Moreover, since A_i is very ample, any base point of $|m_i(A_i + 2F_i)|$ must be contained in F_i . Therefore, $|m_i(A_i + 2F_i)|$ is base point free. Since it is also big, it defines a birational morphism $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ onto a projective surface X_i with $K_{X_i} \sim 0$, which contracts F_i to a simple elliptic singularity. $\square$

Now let $M_{Y_i} := A_i + 2F_i$ be the big and semi-ample Cartier divisor on Y_i , which defines the contraction $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ that contracts F_i to a simple elliptic singularity. Then we have

$$K_{Y_i} + F_i = \pi_i^* K_{X_i} \quad \text{and} \quad \pi_i^* M_i = M_{Y_i},$$

where $M_i := \pi_{i*} M_{Y_i}$. Therefore, (X_i, M_i) is a generalised lc surface with data $Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ and M_{Y_i} . Moreover, $K_{X_i} + M_i$ is ample and

$$\text{vol}(K_{X_i} + M_i) = \text{vol}(K_{Y_i} + F_i + M_{Y_i}) = (11H_i - 3E_i)^2 = 22.$$

Thus,

$$(X_i, M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_0 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$$

for $\Phi = \{0, 1\}$ and $v = 22$.

We claim that the Cartier index of M_i is not bounded. Indeed, assume that there exists $m \in \mathbb{N}$ such that mM_i is Cartier for all i . Then, by the effective base point free theorem [Fuj09, Theorem 1.1] and the very ampleness lemma [Fuj17, Lemma 7.1] for lc pairs, we can find $m' \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $m'M_i$ is very ample for all i . Hence, $m'M_{Y_i}$ is big and base point free for all i , which is a contradiction.

Proposition 4.2. *The set of generalised pairs in $\mathcal{P}_0$ is not bounded.*

Proof. We will show that there is no fixed $r \in \mathbb{N}$ and a very ample divisor N_i on X_i satisfying $N_i \cdot (K_{X_i} + M_i) \leq r$ for all $(X_i, M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_0 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$. Thus, $\mathcal{P}_0$ is not bounded in the sense of §2.2.

Let $N_{Y_i} := \pi_i^* N_i$. Then N_{Y_i} is a big and base point free Cartier divisor on Y_i with $N_{Y_i} \cdot F_i = 0$. Moreover, for any irreducible curve $F'_i \neq F_i$ on Y_i , we have $N_{Y_i} \cdot F'_i > 0$. Writing $N_{Y_i} \sim d_i H_i - \sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} E_{i,j}$ for some integers $d_i, l_{i,1}, \dots, l_{i,11}$, the condition $N_{Y_i} \cdot F_i = 0$ gives

$$(4.2) \quad 3d_i - \sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} = 0.$$

Since $N_{Y_i} \cdot E_{i,j} = l_{i,j} > 0$ for all $1 \leq j \leq 11$, we have $d_i > 0$. For N_{Y_i} to be base point free on Y_i , we must have $N_{Y_i}|_{F_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{F_i}$. Since

$$\begin{aligned} N_{Y_i}|_{F_i} &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(d_i))|_{F_i} \otimes \mathcal{O}_{F_i}(-\sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} \widetilde{p_{i,j}}) \\ &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(d_i)|_C \otimes \mathcal{O}_C(-\sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} p_{i,j})) \\ &= f_i^*(\mathcal{O}_C(\sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} (p_0 - p_{i,j}))), \end{aligned}$$

it follows that

$$(4.3) \quad \mathcal{O}_C(\sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} (p_0 - p_{i,j})) \simeq \mathcal{O}_C.$$

Since the orders $n_{i,1}, \dots, n_{i,10}$ of $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,10}$ are fixed, we can choose a strictly increasing subsequence of $n_{i,11}$, the order of $p_{i,11} - p_0$, such that $n_{i,11}$ is coprime to each of $n_{i,1}, \dots, n_{i,10}$. Thus, we have $l_{i,11} \rightarrow +\infty$ as $i \rightarrow +\infty$ by (4.3). Therefore, (4.2) implies that $d_i \rightarrow +\infty$ as $i \rightarrow +\infty$. Hence, we conclude that

$$N_i \cdot (K_{X_i} + M_i) = N_{Y_i} \cdot M_{Y_i} = 11d_i - 3 \sum_{j=1}^{11} l_{i,j} = 2d_i \rightarrow +\infty$$

as $i \rightarrow +\infty$. □

Remark 4.3. If we choose $p_{i,11}$ such that $\sum_{j=1}^{11} (p_{i,j} - p_0) \in \text{Pic}^0(C)$ is non-torsion, then $A_i + 2F_i$ is nef and big but not semiample in Lemma 4.1. In this case, X_i exists as a complex analytic space [Gra62], or even as an algebraic space [Art70]. However, Y_i cannot be contracted to a projective surface X_i . Indeed, assume that X_i is projective, then there exists a very ample divisor N_i on X_i . By (4.3) in the proof of Proposition 4.2, we have $\mathcal{O}_C(\hat{n}_i l_{i,11} (p_0 - p_{i,11})) \simeq \mathcal{O}_C$, where $\hat{n}_i = \prod_{j=1}^{10} n_{i,j}$, which is a contradiction.

The failure of boundedness of the underlying varieties is more subtle. We also need to take non-projective surfaces into consideration. The following lemma is also mentioned in [Kol22, Example 6], which shows that projectivity is not an open condition in the family of algebraic spaces with singularities slightly worse than rational singularities.

Lemma 4.4. *There exists a family of algebraic spaces $h : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow S$ such that the projective surfaces $X_i \in \mathcal{P}_0$ correspond to a countable dense subset S^τ of S .*

Proof. Fix $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ a smooth elliptic curve and distinct points $p_1, \dots, p_{10} \in C$. Consider the projection

$$\mathbb{P}^2 \times S \rightarrow S \simeq C \setminus \{p_1, \dots, p_{10}\}.$$

Let $g : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow S$ be the family of surfaces given by blowing up the constant sections $p_1 \times S, \dots, p_{10} \times S$ and the diagonal section

$$\Gamma = \{(p_s, s) \in \mathbb{P}^2 \times S \mid s \in S\}$$

in $\mathbb{P}^2 \times S$ where $p_s \in C$ is the point corresponding to $s \in S$ under the given isomorphism $S \simeq C \setminus \{p_1, \dots, p_{10}\}$. Thus, for any $s \in S$, we have that $\mathcal{Y}_s$ is the blow up of $\mathbb{P}^2$ along $p_1, \dots, p_{10}, p_s$. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be the exceptional divisor for $f : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2 \times S$, $\mathcal{H}$ be the pullback of $\mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1) \times S$ via f , and $\mathcal{F}$ be the strict transform of $C \times S$.

Let $\mathcal{I}$ be the ideal sheaf for $\mathcal{F}$ in $\mathcal{Y}$, and $g_0 := g|_{\mathcal{F}} : \mathcal{F} \rightarrow S$. Then $\mathcal{I}/\mathcal{I}^2 \simeq -\mathcal{F}|_{\mathcal{F}}$ is ample over S . Therefore, we have

- (1) For every coherent sheaf $\mathcal{G}$ on $\mathcal{F}$, $R^1 g_{0*}(\mathcal{G} \otimes (\mathcal{I}/\mathcal{I}^2)^{\otimes n}) = 0$ for sufficiently large n , by relative Serre vanishing.
- (2) $R^1 g_{0*}(\mathcal{I}/\mathcal{I}^2)^{\otimes n} = 0$ for every $n \geq 1$, by relative Kodaira vanishing.

By Theorem 2.6, we have a contraction $\pi : \mathcal{Y} \rightarrow \mathcal{X}$ to an algebraic space $\mathcal{X}$ such that the restriction of π to $\mathcal{Y} \setminus \mathcal{F}$ is an isomorphism and it contracts $\mathcal{F}$ to a section of $\mathcal{X} \rightarrow S$. Then the induced family $h : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow S$ is a family of algebraic spaces. Let

$$S^\tau := \{s \in S \mid p_1 + \dots + p_{10} + p_s \text{ is torsion on } C\}, \quad \text{and} \quad S^* := S \setminus S^\tau.$$

Here $p_1 + \dots + p_{10} + p_s$ is the sum in C according to the group law on C . Then by Lemma 4.1, $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{Y}} := 11\mathcal{H} - 3\mathcal{E}$ is nef and big over S . Moreover, $(\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{Y}})_s$ is semiample for $s \in S^\tau$, which contracts $\mathcal{Y}_s$ to a projective surface $\mathcal{X}_s$, while $(\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{Y}})_s$ is not semiample for $s \in S^*$. Thus $\mathcal{X}_s$ is projective if and only if $s \in S^\tau$. $\square$

Theorem 4.5. *The set of underlying varieties appearing in $\mathcal{P}_0$ is not bounded.*

Proof. Let $g : \mathcal{Y} \xrightarrow{\pi} \mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{h} S$ be the two families obtained in Lemma 4.4, where $\mathcal{Y}$ is projective over S but $\mathcal{X}$ is not projective over S ($\mathcal{X}_s$ is projective if and only if $s \in S^\tau$). Suppose that the set $\{\mathcal{X}_s \mid s \in S^\tau\}$ is bounded. Then, there exists a projective family $h' : \mathcal{X}' \rightarrow T$ such that for every $s \in S^\tau$, there exists some $t = t(s) \in T$ with $\mathcal{X}_s \cong \mathcal{X}'_t$. We

may assume that $\mathcal{X}' \rightarrow T$ is a locally closed subset of the corresponding Hilbert scheme. After replacing T with the closure of S^τ in T , we may assume that S^τ is dense in T .

After replacing T with a dense open subset and S^τ with the corresponding subset, we can take a common minimal resolution of $\mathcal{X}'_t$, and it is just the blowing up of a section of $\mathcal{X}' \rightarrow T$, and so we get a morphism $\pi' : \mathcal{Y}' \rightarrow \mathcal{X}'$ with an irreducible exceptional divisor $\mathcal{F}'$. Moreover, for every $s \in S^\tau$, there exists some $t = t(s) \in T$ such that $\mathcal{Y}'_t \supset \mathcal{F}'_t \cong \mathcal{F}_s \subset \mathcal{Y}_s$, where $\mathcal{F}_s$ is the strict transform of the elliptic curve $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$.

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 \mathcal{Y} & & \mathcal{Y}_s & \simeq & \mathcal{Y}'_t & & \mathcal{Y}' \longrightarrow \mathcal{U} \\
 \downarrow \pi & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \pi' \\
 \mathcal{X} & & \mathcal{X}_s & \simeq & \mathcal{X}'_t & & \mathcal{X}' \\
 \downarrow h & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow h' \\
 S \supset S^\tau \ni s & \longrightarrow & t = t(s) & \in & T & \longrightarrow & H
 \end{array}$$

Fix a relatively very ample divisor $\mathcal{A}'$ for $g' : \mathcal{Y}' \rightarrow T$ such that $H^1(\mathcal{Y}'_t, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}'_t}(\mathcal{A}'_t)) = 0$ for $t \in T$. Let $\mathcal{U} \rightarrow H$ be the corresponding universal family over the Hilbert scheme H . Then there is a morphism $T \rightarrow H$ such that $\mathcal{Y}' = \mathcal{U}_T := \mathcal{U} \times_H T$. For every $s \in S^\tau$, we have a corresponding very ample divisor $\mathcal{A}_s$ of fixed degree on $\mathcal{Y}_s$. Since $H^i(\mathcal{Y}_s, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}_s}) = 0$ for $i = 1, 2$ and $s \in S$, then $H^1(\mathcal{Y}_s, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}_s}^*) \cong H^2(\mathcal{Y}_s, \mathbb{Z})$ for $s \in S$. Thus, after replacing S with an étale cover, there exists a line bundle $\mathcal{L}$ on $\mathcal{Y}$ such that $\mathcal{L}_s \cong \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}_s}(\mathcal{A}_s)$ for every $s \in S^\tau$. Since $H^1(\mathcal{Y}_s, \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{Y}_s}(\mathcal{A}_s)) = 0$ for $s \in S^\tau$, by [Nug24, Proposition 7.7], after replacing S with an open neighborhood of some $s \in S^\tau$, we may assume that $\mathcal{L}_s$ is very ample with a fixed degree for all $s \in S$. This yields a morphism $S \rightarrow H$ such that $\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{U}_S := \mathcal{U} \times_H S$.

Note that the closures of the images of S and T in H coincide, leading to a common cover $R \rightarrow S$ and $R \rightarrow T$ such that $\mathcal{Y}_R := \mathcal{Y} \times_S R$ coincides with $\mathcal{Y}'_R := \mathcal{Y}' \times_T R$. Consequently, for every $s \in S$, there exists some $t \in T$ with an isomorphism $\mathcal{Y}_s \cong \mathcal{Y}'_t$.

Let $\mathcal{N}'$ be the pullback of a relative very ample divisor on $\mathcal{X}'$ to $\mathcal{Y}'$. Then for every $s \in S$, there exists some $t \in T$ such that $\mathcal{N}'_t \subset \mathcal{Y}'_t$ gives a base point free divisor $\mathcal{N}_s \subset \mathcal{Y}_s$. However, $|\mathcal{N}_s|$ contracts $\mathcal{F}_s$, where $\mathcal{F}_s$ is the strict transform of the elliptic curve $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$, which implies that $\mathcal{X}_s$ is projective, leading to a contradiction. $\square$

Remark 4.6. We say that X is a *polarized Calabi-Yau variety* if X is slc, $K_X \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} 0$, and there exists an ample $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier Weil divisor M on X .

Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$ and $v \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. Fix $\dim X = d$ and $\text{vol}(M) = v$. In this subsection, we construct a set of polarized Calabi-Yau varieties with $d = 2$, and $v = 22$. Our example shows that to bound X , we cannot remove the klt condition in [Bir23, Corollary 1.6], or the condition that $M \geq 0$ and (X, tM) is slc for some $0 < t \ll 1$ in [Bir23, Corollary 1.8].

Example 4.7. We say that (W, D) is a *boundary polarized Calabi-Yau pair* [ABB⁺23, BL24] if (W, D) is slc, $K_W + D \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} 0$, and D is an ample $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier $\mathbb{Q}$ -divisor on W . Note that $-K_W$ is ample and so W is an slc Fano variety.

Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$ and $v \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. Fix $\dim W = d$ and $\text{vol}(-K_W) = v$. For $(X_i, M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_0$ constructed in this subsection, let

$$W_i = C_p(X_i, M_i) := \text{Proj} \bigoplus_{n=0}^{\infty} \bigoplus_{m=0}^{\infty} H^0(X_i, \mathcal{O}_{X_i}(mM_i)) \cdot t^n$$

be the projective cone over X_i , and $X_i^{\infty} \simeq X_i$ be the divisor at infinity. Then by [ABB⁺23, Proposition 2.20.3], (W_i, X_i^{∞}) is a boundary polarized Calabi-Yau pair. Let $\gamma_i : V_i \rightarrow W_i$ be the blow up of the vertex with exceptional divisor X_i^- , set $X_i^+ = \gamma_i^* X_i^{\infty}$, and let $\beta_i : V_i \rightarrow X_i$ be the associated $\mathbb{P}^1$ -bundle. Let $\tau_i : U_i \rightarrow V_i$ be the resolution of singularities with exceptional divisor $R_{F_i} \simeq \alpha_i^* F_i$ where $\alpha_i : U_i \rightarrow Y_i$ is the associated $\mathbb{P}^1$ -bundle, and set $Y_i^{\pm} = \tau_i^* X_i^{\pm}$. We have the following commutative diagram.

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} (U_i, R_{F_i} + Y_i^- + Y_i^+) & \xrightarrow{\tau_i} & (V_i, X_i^- + X_i^+) & \xrightarrow{\gamma_i} & (W_i, X_i^{\infty}) \\ \downarrow \alpha_i & & \downarrow \beta_i & & \\ (Y_i, F_i + M_{Y_i}) & \xrightarrow{\pi_i} & (X_i, M_i) & & \end{array}$$

We claim that the Cartier index of $-K_{W_i}$ is unbounded, and hence (W_i, X_i^{∞}) is unbounded by the same argument as in [BH22, §5.3, p.20]. Indeed, if the Cartier index of $-K_{W_i}$ is bounded, then by [JL21, Corollary 1.6], there exists $q \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $q(K_{W_i} + X_i^{\infty}) \sim 0$ for all i . Hence, the Cartier index of X_i^{∞} is also bounded. Since $X_i^{\infty} - (-K_{W_i})$ is ample, by the effective base point free theorem [Fuj09, Theorem 1.1] and the very ampleness lemma [Fuj17, Lemma 7.1] for lc pairs, we can find $l \in \mathbb{N}$ such that lX_i^{∞} is very ample for all i . Therefore, $lX_i^+ = \gamma_i^*(lX_i^{\infty})$ is big and base point free on V_i for all i . However, since $Y_i^+|_{Y_i^+} \sim M_{Y_i}$, it follows that $X_i^+|_{X_i^+} \sim M_i$, which implies that the Cartier index of X_i^+ is not bounded, leading to a contradiction.

Note that $(U_i, \alpha_i^* F_i + Y_i^- + Y_i^+)$ is a dlt modification of (W_i, X_i^{∞}) with minimal non-klt centers $F_i^- := R_{F_i} \cap Y_i^- \simeq F_i$ and $F_i^+ := R_{F_i} \cap Y_i^+ \simeq F_i$. Therefore, we obtain an unbounded set of boundary polarized Calabi-Yau 3-fold pairs (W_i, X_i^{∞}) such that $\text{vol}(-K_{W_i}) = (X_i^{\infty})^3 = M_i^2 = 22$ and $\text{reg}(W_i, X_i^{\infty}) = 1$ (see [ABB⁺23, Definition 8.5]). This case is not treated in [ABB⁺23, §8].

4.2. Minimal surfaces of Kodaira dimension one. In this subsection, we construct an unbounded set of generalised pairs $(U_i, B_{U_i} + M_{U_i}) \in \mathcal{P}_1 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ for $\Phi = \{0, 1\}$ and $v = 68$, such that K_{U_i} is semiample with $\kappa(U_i) = 1$, $B_{U_i} = 0$, and M_{U_i} is an ample Weil divisor with unbounded Cartier index.

In the example of §4.1, let $D \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be another smooth elliptic curve, and assume that $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,9} \in C \cap D$. We first blow up $\mathbb{P}^2$ at $p_{i,1}, \dots, p_{i,9}$, giving a pencil spanned by

the strict transforms of C and D . Then, we further blow up $p_{i,10}$ and $p_{i,11}$ on the strict transform of C , we obtain a surface Y_i with a morphism $Y_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$. Let M_{Y_i} be the big and semiample Cartier divisor on Y_i that defines a contraction $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ which contracts the strict transform F_i of C on Y_i . Let $M_i = \pi_{i*} M_{Y_i}$, and let $X_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ be the induced morphism.

Let $G_{i,1}$ and $G_{i,2}$ be two general fibers of $Y_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ that do not contain F_i . Let $\nu_i : V_i \rightarrow Y_i$ be the double cover of Y_i branched over $G_{i,1}$ and $G_{i,2}$, then $M_{V_i} := \nu_i^* M_{Y_i}$ is also a big and semiample Cartier divisor. Since Y_i is smooth and $G_{i,1}, G_{i,2}$ are disjoint smooth fibers, it follows that V_i is also smooth. Let $\mu_i : U_i \rightarrow X_i$ be the double cover of X_i branched over $\pi_{i*} G_{i,1}$ and $\pi_{i*} G_{i,2}$, then $M_{U_i} := \mu_i^* M_i$ is also ample with unbounded Cartier index. We have the following commutative diagram, where $\tau_i : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ is a double cover branched over two points.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
(V_i, \nu_i^* F_i + M_{V_i}) & \xrightarrow{\nu_i} & (Y_i, F_i + M_{Y_i}) \\
\downarrow \gamma_i & & \downarrow \pi_i \\
(U_i, M_{U_i}) & \xrightarrow{\mu_i} & (X_i, M_i) \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow \\
\mathbb{P}^1 & \xrightarrow{\tau_i} & \mathbb{P}^1
\end{array}$$

Since $(Y_i, F_i + \frac{1}{2}(G_{i,1} + G_{i,2}) + M_{Y_i})$ is generalised lc, and

$$K_{V_i} + \nu_i^* F_i + M_{V_i} = \nu_i^* (K_{Y_i} + F_i + \frac{1}{2}(G_{i,1} + G_{i,2}) + M_{Y_i}),$$

by [KM98, Proposition 5.20], $(V_i, \nu_i^* F_i + M_{V_i})$ is also generalised lc. Since

$$\gamma_i^* K_{U_i} = K_{V_i} + \nu_i^* F_i \quad \text{and} \quad \gamma_i^* M_{U_i} = M_{V_i},$$

it follows that (U_i, M_{U_i}) is a generalised lc surface with data $V_i \rightarrow U_i$ and M_{V_i} . Moreover,

$$K_{U_i} = \mu_i^* (K_{X_i} + \frac{1}{2}(\pi_{i*} G_{i,1} + \pi_{i*} G_{i,2}))$$

is semiample with $\kappa(K_{U_i}) = 1$.

Recall that $M_{Y_i} \sim 11H_i - 3E_i$, and $G_{i,1} \sim G_{i,2} \sim 3H_i - (E_{i,1} + \cdots + E_{i,9})$. We have

$$M_i \cdot \pi_{i*} G_{i,k} = M_{Y_i} \cdot G_{i,k} = 33 - 3 \times 9 = 6$$

for $k = 1, 2$. Now, $K_{U_i} + M_{U_i}$ is ample and

$$\begin{aligned} \text{vol}(K_{U_i} + M_{U_i}) &= \mu_i^*(K_{X_i} + \frac{1}{2}(\pi_{i*}G_{i,1} + \pi_{i*}G_{i,2}) + M_i)^2 \\ &= 2(K_{X_i} + \frac{1}{2}(\pi_{i*}G_{i,1} + \pi_{i*}G_{i,2}) + M_i)^2 \\ &= 2(2M_i \cdot \pi_{i*}G_{i,2} + M_i^2) \\ &= 2(12 + 22) \\ &= 68. \end{aligned}$$

Thus

$$(U_i, M_{U_i}) \in \mathcal{P}_1 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$$

for $\Phi = \{0, 1\}$ and $v = 68$.

Remark 4.8. If we choose $p_{i,11}$ such that $\sum_{j=1}^{11}(p_{i,j} - p_0) \in \text{Pic}^0(C)$ is non-torsion, then U_i is not projective. Indeed, assume that U_i is projective, then there exists an ample divisor N_{U_i} on U_i . Since the double cover $\mu_i : U_i \rightarrow X_i$ is always a Galois cover with group $G = \mathbb{Z}_2$, define $N_{U_i}^G := \frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{g \in G} g^* N_{U_i}$. Then $N_{U_i}^G$ is G -invariant, so there exists an ample divisor N_i on X_i such that $N_{U_i}^G = \mu_i^* N_i$. This implies that X_i is projective, which is a contradiction.

Theorem 4.9. *The set of underlying varieties appearing in $\mathcal{P}_1$ is not bounded.*

Proof. Suppose that U_i belongs to a bounded family. The induced fibration $U_i \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ is just the Iitaka fibration and hence it also belongs to a bounded family. Let $\alpha_i : U_i \rightarrow U_i$ be the involution that fixes the ramification divisor of $\mu_i : U_i \rightarrow X_i$. From the construction in this subsection, we know that the involution α_i is determined by an involution $\beta : \mathbb{P}^1 \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^1$ that fixes two points of $\mathbb{P}^1$, and hence α_i is bounded.

It then follows that $X_i = U_i / \langle \alpha_i \rangle$ is also bounded, which contradicts Theorem 4.5. $\square$

Remark 4.10. We say that U is a *stable minimal model* if U is slc, K_U is semiample defining a contraction $f : U \rightarrow Z$, and there exists a $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier Weil divisor M_U on U which is ample over Z . In particular, F is a polarized Calabi-Yau variety with polarization $M_U|_F$, where F is the general fiber of $f : U \rightarrow Z$.

Let $d \in \mathbb{N}$, $\sigma \in \mathbb{Q}[t]$ be a polynomial, and $u \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$. Fix $\dim U = d$, $(K_U + tM_U)^d = \sigma(t)$, and $\text{vol}(M_U|_F) = u$. In this subsection, we have constructed a set of stable minimal models with $d = 2$, $\sigma(t) = 24t + 44t^2$, and $u = 12$. Our example shows that to bound U , we cannot remove the klt condition in [Jia23, Theorem 1.3], or the condition that $M_U \geq 0$ and (U, tM_U) is slc for some $0 < t \ll 1$ in [Bir22, Theorem 1.12]. Moreover, in our example, both the general fiber F and the base Z are bounded, while previously known

examples of the failure of boundedness of stable minimal models with fixed (d, σ, u) arise from the failure of boundedness of the general fibers.

4.3. Minimal surfaces of general type. In this subsection, we construct an unbounded set of generalised pairs $(X_i, B_i + M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_2 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ such that K_{X_i} is nef and big but not ample, $B_i = 0$, and M_i is an ample divisor with unbounded Cartier index.

Let $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be a smooth cubic, and take r general lines $L_j \subset \mathbb{P}^2$. Let $h : W \rightarrow \mathbb{P}^2$ be the blow up of all singular points of $C + \sum L_j$. Denote the strict transform of $C + \sum L_j$ by $C' + \sum L'_j$. Define $H := h^* \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(1)$. For $1 \leq j \leq r$, $1 \leq l \leq 3$, let E_{jl} be the exceptional divisor over $C \cap L_j$. Similarly, for $1 \leq j < k \leq r$, let F_{jk} be the exceptional divisor over $L_j \cap L_k$. Let $\tau : W \rightarrow Z$ be the contraction of $C' + \sum L'_j$. Then Z has one simple elliptic singularity (the image of C) and r quotient singularities (the image of the L_j). Moreover, K_Z is ample if $r \geq 4$. Since our computation does not coincide with [Kol21, Example 5] (where it is stated that K_Z is ample if $r \geq 6$), we provide the details of the computation.

Lemma 4.11. *If $r \geq 4$, then K_Z is ample.*

Proof. Note that we have the following relations:

$$(4.4) \quad K_W = h^* K_{\mathbb{P}^2} + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r, 1 \leq l \leq 3} E_{jl} + \sum_{1 \leq j < k \leq r} F_{jk},$$

$$(4.5) \quad C' = 3H - \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r, 1 \leq l \leq 3} E_{jl},$$

$$(4.6) \quad L'_j = H - \sum_{1 \leq l \leq 3} E_{jl} - \sum_{1 \leq k \leq r, k \neq j} F_{jk}.$$

From (4.5) and (4.6), we deduce that

$$(4.7) \quad 2 \sum_{1 \leq j < k \leq r} F_{jk} = \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} (H - \sum_{1 \leq l \leq 3} E_{jl} - L'_j) = rH - (3H - C') - \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} L'_j.$$

Then by (4.4), (4.5), and (4.7), we have

$$K_W = \frac{r-3}{2}H - \frac{1}{2}C' - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} L'_j.$$

Since L'_j is a rational curve with $(L'_j)^2 = 1 - 3 - (r-1) = -1 - r$, the log discrepancy is given by $a(L'_j, Z, 0) = \frac{2}{r+1}$. Thus, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \tau^* K_Z &= K_W + C' + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} \left(1 - \frac{2}{r+1}\right) L'_j \\ &= \frac{r-3}{2}H + \frac{1}{2}C' + \frac{r-3}{2(r+1)} \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} L'_j. \end{aligned}$$

If $r \geq 4$, then for any irreducible curve $\tilde{C}$ such that $\tilde{C} \neq C'$ and $\tilde{C} \neq L'_j$ for all j , we have $\tau^*K_Z \cdot \tilde{C} \geq \frac{r-3}{2} > 0$. Since $\tau^*K_Z \cdot C' = \tau^*K_Z \cdot L'_j = 0$, it follows that if $r \geq 4$, then

$$\begin{aligned} (\tau^*K_Z)^2 &= (K_W + C' + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} (1 - \frac{2}{r+1})L'_j) \cdot K_W \\ &= K_W^2 - C'^2 + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} (1 - \frac{2}{r+1})(-2 - L_j'^2) \\ &= (9 - 3r - \frac{r(r-1)}{2}) + (3r - 9) + r(1 - \frac{2}{r+1})(-2 + r + 1) \\ &= \frac{r(r-1)(r-3)}{2(r+1)} > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, by the Nakai-Moishezon criterion, K_Z is ample if $r \geq 4$. $\square$

Pick a point $p_i \in C' \setminus (C' \cap \sum L'_j) \subset W$ such that p_i is torsion with order n_i . Let $g_i : Y_i \rightarrow W$ be the blow up of W at p_i with exceptional divisor E_i , and denote by $C'_i + \sum L'_{ij}$ the strict transform of $C' + \sum L'_j$ on Y_i . Then $g_i^*C' = C'_i + E_i$. Define $H_i := g_i^*H$, $E_{ijl} := g_i^*E_{jl}$ for $1 \leq j \leq r$, $1 \leq l \leq 3$, and $F_{ijk} := g_i^*F_{jk}$ for $1 \leq j < k \leq r$. Let $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ be the contraction of $C'_i + \sum L'_{ij}$. Define $E_{X_i} := \pi_{i*}E_i$. Then $f_i : X_i \rightarrow Z$ is a contraction with a single exceptional divisor E_{X_i} . We have the following commutative diagram.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (Y_i \supset H_i, C'_i, L'_{ij}, E_i, E_{ijl}, F_{ijk}) & \xrightarrow{g_i} & (W \supset H, C', L'_j, E_{jl}, F_{jk}) \xrightarrow{h} \mathbb{P}^2 \\ \downarrow \pi_i & & \downarrow \tau \\ (X_i \supset E_{X_i}) & \xrightarrow{f_i} & Z \end{array}$$

Lemma 4.12. *K_{X_i} is nef and big but not ample.*

Proof. We may write

$$K_{X_i} = f_i^*K_Z + mE_{X_i}$$

for some $m \in \mathbb{Q}$. Then, together with the following relations:

$$\begin{aligned} (4.8) \quad K_W + C' + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} (1 - \frac{2}{r+1})L'_j &= \tau^*K_Z, \\ K_{Y_i} &= g_i^*K_W + E_i, \\ K_{Y_i} + C'_i + \sum_{1 \leq j \leq r} (1 - \frac{2}{r+1})L'_{ij} &= \pi_i^*K_{X_i}, \\ g_i^*C' &= E_i + C'_i, \\ g_i^*L'_j &= L'_{ij}, \end{aligned}$$

we deduce that $m = 0$, hence $K_{X_i} = f_i^*K_Z$ is nef and big. Moreover, since $K_{X_i} \cdot E_{X_i} = 0$, it follows that K_{X_i} is not ample. $\square$

We aim to construct an ample $\mathbb{Q}$ -Cartier divisor M_i on X_i such that its Cartier index is unbounded. The argument is similar to Lemma 4.1.

Fix $r \geq 4$ and let $d \geq 2(3r + \binom{r}{2} + 2)$ be a fixed positive integer. Then, by Theorem 2.2,

$$A_i := dH_i - \sum E_{ijl} - \sum F_{ijk} - E_i$$

is very ample on Y_i .

Let $a = -A_i \cdot C'_i / (C'_i)^2 > 0$ and $b = -A_i \cdot L'_{ij} / (L'_{ij})^2 > 0$ which is independent of j , then

$$\begin{cases} (A_i + aC'_i + b \sum L'_{ij}) \cdot C'_i = 0, \\ (A_i + aC'_i + b \sum L'_{ij}) \cdot L'_{ik} = 0, \end{cases}$$

holds for any k . Let $q \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $M_{Y_i} := q(A_i + aC'_i + b \sum L'_{ij})$ is an integral divisor. It follows that $M_{Y_i} \cdot \tilde{C}_i > 0$ for any irreducible curve $\tilde{C}_i$ on Y_i with $\tilde{C}_i \neq C'_i$ and $\tilde{C}_i \neq L'_{ij}$ for all j , and hence M_{Y_i} is nef. Moreover, since M_{Y_i} is the sum of an ample divisor and effective divisors, it follows that M_{Y_i} is big. Let $m_i \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i}) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{C'_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{C'_i}$, where m_i depends on the torsion order of p_i .

Lemma 4.13. *The linear system $|m_i M_{Y_i}|$ is base point free.*

Proof. Let D_i be either the curve C'_i or L'_{ij} , since $D_i^2 < 0$ and $g(D_i) \leq 1$, we have $H^1(D_i, \mathcal{I}_{D_i}^t / \mathcal{I}_{D_i}^{t+1}) = 0$ for $t \geq 1$, where $\mathcal{I}_{D_i} := \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(-D_i)$ is the ideal sheaf of D_i in Y_i . Thus, the cohomology sequence induced by the truncated exponential exact sequences

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{I}_{D_i}^t / \mathcal{I}_{D_i}^{t+1} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{(t+1)D_i}^* \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{tD_i}^* \rightarrow 0$$

yields the fact that the restriction maps

$$\text{Pic}((t+1)D_i) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(tD_i)$$

are isomorphisms for all $t \geq 1$. Define $G_i := m_i q(aC'_i + b \sum L'_{ij})$. Since

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i}) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{\text{Supp}(G_i)} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{\text{Supp}(G_i)},$$

we have

$$\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i}) \otimes \mathcal{O}_{G_i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{G_i}.$$

Thus, we obtain the following short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i} - G_i) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i}) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{G_i} \rightarrow 0.$$

This gives the long exact sequence

$$H^0(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i})) \rightarrow H^0(G_i, \mathcal{O}_{G_i}) \rightarrow H^1(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i q A_i)).$$

Since $m_i q A_i - K_{Y_i}$ is very ample by Theorem 2.2, it follows that $H^1(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i q A_i)) = 0$ by Kodaira's vanishing. Therefore, $H^0(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(m_i M_{Y_i})) \rightarrow H^0(G_i, \mathcal{O}_{G_i})$ is surjective, and hence the base points of $|m_i M_{Y_i}|$ are not contained in $\text{Supp}(G_i)$. Moreover, since A_i is

very ample, any base point of $|m_i M_{Y_i}|$ must be contained in C'_i or L'_{ij} . Thus, $|m_i M_{Y_i}|$ is base point free. $\square$

Now, let $M_i := \pi_{i*} M_{Y_i}$ be the corresponding ample divisor on X_i , where the Cartier index of M_i is unbounded. Then $M_{Y_i} = \pi^* M_i$, and it follows from (4.8) that (X_i, M_i) is a generalised lc surface with data $Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ and M_{Y_i} . Moreover, $K_{X_i} + M_i$ is ample and $\text{vol}(K_{X_i} + M_i)$ is fixed. Thus,

$$(X_i, M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_2 \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$$

for $\Phi = \{0, 1\}$ and some fixed v .

Theorem 4.14. *The set of underlying varieties appearing in $\mathcal{P}_2$ is not bounded.*

Proof. If we choose a non-torsion point $p_i \in C' \setminus (C' \cap \sum L'_j) \subset W$, then by the same argument as in Remark 4.3, X_i is non-projective. Moreover, we have

$$H^1(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}) = H^2(Y_i, \mathcal{O}_{Y_i}) = 0$$

for every choice of $p_i \in C' \setminus (C' \cap \sum L'_j) \subset W$. Therefore, we can use the same argument as in Theorem 4.5 to show that $\mathcal{P}_2$ is not bounded. $\square$

Remark 4.15. Given a variety Z and a birational contraction $f : X \rightarrow Z$, we can write

$$K_X + B = f^* K_Z$$

for some uniquely determined B . We say (X, B) is a *crepant model* of Z if $B \geq 0$. By the birational case of [Bir24, Theorem 1.2], we know that if Z is ϵ -lc for some fixed $\epsilon \in \mathbb{Q}^{>0}$ and it belongs to a bounded family, then the underlying varieties of all the crepant models of Z form a bounded family. Our example in this subsection shows that the ϵ -lc condition is necessary.

4.4. Weak Fano surfaces. In this subsection, we construct an unbounded set of generalised pairs $(X_i, B_i + M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_{-\infty} \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$ for $\Phi = \{0, \frac{1}{8}\}$ and $v = \frac{45}{16}$, such that $-K_{X_i}$ is nef and big but not ample, $B_i = 0$, and M_i is an ample $\mathbb{Q}$ -divisor with unbounded Cartier index. Our example is inspired by [Kol07, 2.19].

Let $C \subset \mathbb{P}^2$ be a smooth elliptic curve, and Z be the projective cone over C . Then Z is a Fano surface with $\rho(Z) = 1$, and $K_Z + C^\infty \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} 0$, where C^∞ is the section of Z at infinity. Let $\tau : W \rightarrow Z$ be the blow up of the vertex with exceptional divisor C^- , and $W \rightarrow C$ be the associated $\mathbb{P}^1$ -bundle. Fix $p_0 \in C^-$, then we can embed C^- into $\mathbb{P}^2$ such that p_0 serves as the identity element of the group structure on C^- . Let C^+ be the positive section of $W \rightarrow C$, and F be a fiber of $W \rightarrow C$. By [Har77, Proposition V.2.3], we have $\text{Pic}(W) = \mathbb{Z}C^- \oplus \mathbb{Z}F$, and $C^+ = C^- + 3F$. Moreover, We have

$$-(C^-)^2 = (C^+)^2 = 3, \quad C^+ \cdot F = C^- \cdot F = 1, \quad \text{and} \quad F^2 = 0.$$

Pick a point $p_i \in C^- \subset W$ such that the divisor $p_i - p_0 \in \text{Pic}^0(C^-)$ has order n_i . Let $g_i : Y_i \rightarrow W$ be the blow up of W at p_i with exceptional divisor E_i . Then Y_i is bounded by [Ale94, Lemma 3.8]. Denote $C_i^\pm := g_i^* C^\pm$ and $F_i := g_i^* F$ on Y_i . Then we have $C_i^- = E_i + G_i^-$, where G_i^- is the strict transform of C^- on Y_i . Since

$$-3 = (C_i^-)^2 = (E_i + G_i^-)^2 = -1 + 2 + (G_i^-)^2,$$

it follows that $(G_i^-)^2 = -4$. By [Har77, Proposition V.3.2], we have

$$\text{Pic}(Y_i) = \mathbb{Z}C_i^- \oplus \mathbb{Z}F_i \oplus \mathbb{Z}E_i.$$

Let $\pi_i : Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ be the contraction that contracts G_i^- . Define $E_{X_i} := \pi_{i*} E_i$. Then $f_i : X_i \rightarrow Z$ is a contraction with a single exceptional divisor E_{X_i} . Write $\pi_i^* E_{X_i} = E_i + nG_i^-$. From $\pi_i^* E_{X_i} \cdot G_i^- = 0$, we deduce that $1 + n(-4) = 0$, hence $n = \frac{1}{4}$. Therefore,

$$(E_{X_i})^2 = (E_i + \frac{1}{4}G_i^-)^2 = (-1 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{16}(-4)) = -\frac{3}{4}.$$

Let $C_{X_i}^+ := f_i^* C^\infty$. We have the following commutative diagram.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (Y_i \supset C_i^+, C_i^-, F_i, E_i, G_i^-) & \xrightarrow{g_i} & (W \supset C^+, C^-, F) \longrightarrow C \\ \downarrow \pi_i & & \downarrow \tau \\ (X_i \supset C_{X_i}^+, E_{X_i}) & \xrightarrow{f_i} & (Z \supset C^\infty) \end{array}$$

Lemma 4.16. $-K_{X_i}$ is nef and big but not ample.

Proof. Assume that

$$K_{X_i} = f_i^* K_Z + mE_{X_i}$$

for some $m \in \mathbb{Q}$. Then, together with the following relations:

$$K_W + C^- = \tau^* K_Z,$$

$$K_{Y_i} = g_i^* K_W + E_i,$$

$$K_{Y_i} + G_i^- = \pi_i^* K_{X_i},$$

$$g_i^* C^- = E_i + G_i^-,$$

we deduce that $m = 0$, hence $-K_{X_i} = -f_i^* K_Z$ is nef and big. Moreover, since $-K_{X_i} \cdot E_{X_i} = 0$, it follows that $-K_{X_i}$ is not ample. $\square$

Lemma 4.17. $N_i := C_{X_i}^+ - \frac{1}{2}E_{X_i}$ is ample on X_i .

Proof. Let

$$N_{Y_i} := \pi_i^* N_i = (C_i^- + 3F_i) - \frac{1}{2}(E_i + \frac{1}{4}(C_i^- - E_i)) = \frac{7}{8}C_i^- + 3F_i - \frac{3}{8}E_i.$$

Note that

$$N_i^2 = (N_{Y_i})^2 = (C_{X_i}^+)^2 + \frac{1}{4}(E_{X_i})^2 = 3 + \frac{1}{4}(-\frac{3}{4}) = \frac{45}{16} > 0.$$

Thus, to show that N_i is ample, it suffices to check that $N_{Y_i} \cdot C'_i > 0$ for any irreducible curve $C'_i \neq G_i^-$ on Y_i by the Nakai-Moishezon criterion.

Let $L_i := 5C_i^- + 24F_i - E_i$, then L_i is very ample by Theorem 2.5. Moreover, we have

$$L_i + 2G_i^- = 5C_i^- + 24F_i - E_i + 2(C_i^- - E_i) = 8N_{Y_i}.$$

It follows that

$$8N_{Y_i} \cdot C'_i = (L_i + 2G_i^-) \cdot C'_i > 0$$

for any irreducible curve $C'_i \neq G_i^-$ on Y_i . $\square$

Remark 4.18. The Cartier index of E_{X_i} is unbounded. Indeed, if it were bounded, then, since the Cartier index of $C_{X_i}^+$ is bounded, it follows that the Cartier index of $N_i = C_{X_i}^+ - \frac{1}{2}E_{X_i}$ is also bounded. Since $N_i - K_{X_i}$ is ample, by the effective base point free theorem [Fuj09, Theorem 1.1] and the very ampleness lemma [Fuj17, Lemma 7.1] for lc pairs, there exists $l \in \mathbb{N}$ such that lN_i is very ample for all i . Then $\pi_i^*(8lN_i) \sim 8lC_i^+ - 4lE_i - lG_i^-$ is base point free on Y_i , and thus $\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(8lC_i^+ - 4lE_i - lG_i^-)|_{G_i^-} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{G_i^-}$. It follows that $\mathcal{O}_{C^-}(3lp_i) \simeq \mathcal{O}_{\mathbb{P}^2}(l)|_{C^-} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{C^-}(3lp_0)$ for all i , which is a contradiction. Similarly, we can show that if we choose $p_i \in C^- \subset W$ such that the divisor $p_i - p_0 \in \text{Pic}^0(C^-)$ is non-torsion, then no multiple of E_{X_i} is Cartier.

Note that in our example, Z is fixed and Y_i is bounded. However, since the Cartier index of E_{X_i} is unbounded, by the proof of [Kol07, Claim 2.19.1], we deduce that X_i cannot be obtained from Z by blowing up a zero-dimensional subscheme of bounded length. Thus, we cannot apply the "sandwich" argument in [Ale94, Proof of Theorem 6.9] to get the boundedness of X_i .

Now, $M_i := 2C_{X_i}^+ - \frac{1}{2}E_{X_i}$ is an ample $\mathbb{Q}$ -divisor on X_i with unbounded Cartier index. Then,

$$M_{Y_i} := \pi_i^* M_i = 2C_i^+ - \frac{1}{2}(E_i + \frac{1}{4}G_i^-) = \frac{1}{8}(16C_i^+ - 4E_i - G_i^-)$$

is nef and big, and hence $16C_i^+ - 4E_i - G_i^-$ is a nef Cartier divisor on Y_i . Moreover, $(Y_i, G_i^- + M_{Y_i})$ is a generalised lc pair. Therefore, (X_i, M_i) is a generalised lc surface with data $Y_i \rightarrow X_i$ and M_{Y_i} . Moreover, $K_{X_i} + M_i \sim_{\mathbb{Q}} C_{X_i}^+ - \frac{1}{2}E_{X_i}$ is ample and

$$\text{vol}(K_{X_i} + M_i) = (C_{X_i}^+)^2 + \frac{1}{4}(E_{X_i})^2 = \frac{45}{16}.$$

Thus,

$$(X_i, M_i) \in \mathcal{P}_{-\infty} \subset \mathcal{F}_{glc}(2, \Phi, v)$$

for $\Phi = \{0, \frac{1}{8}\}$ and $v = \frac{45}{16}$.

Theorem 4.19. *The set of underlying varieties appearing in $\mathcal{P}_{-\infty}$ is not bounded.*

Proof. We will show that there is no fixed $r \in \mathbb{N}$ and a very ample divisor H_i on X_i satisfying $H_i^2 \leq r$ for all i . Thus, X_i is not bounded.

Let $H_{Y_i} := \pi_i^* H_i$, then H_{Y_i} is a big and base point free Cartier divisor on Y_i , which contracts only G_i^- . Since $\text{Pic}(Y_i) = \mathbb{Z}C_i^+ \oplus \mathbb{Z}F_i \oplus \mathbb{Z}E_i$, write

$$H_{Y_i} \sim a_i C_i^+ + b_i F_i + c_i E_i,$$

then we have

$$H_{Y_i} \cdot G_i^- = 0, \quad H_{Y_i} \cdot E_i > 0, \quad \text{and} \quad H_{Y_i} \cdot C_i^+ > 0,$$

which implies

$$(4.9) \quad b_i = -c_i, \quad -c_i > 0, \quad \text{and} \quad 3a_i + b_i > 0.$$

Moreover, we have

$$\begin{aligned} H_i^2 &= (a_i C_i^+ + b_i F_i - b_i E_i)^2 \\ &= (a_i C_i^+ + b_i F_i)^2 + b_i^2 E_i^2 \\ &= 3a_i^2 + 2a_i b_i - b_i^2 \\ (4.10) \quad &= (a_i + b_i)(3a_i - b_i) > 0. \end{aligned}$$

Combining (4.9) and (4.10), we obtain $a_i + b_i > 0$ and $3a_i - b_i > 0$. For H_{Y_i} to be base point free on Y_i , we must have $H_{Y_i}|_{G_i^-} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{G_i^-}$, which gives $\mathcal{O}_{Y_i}(3(a_i C_i^+ + b_i F_i - b_i E_i))|_{G_i^-} \simeq \mathcal{O}_{G_i^-}$, and hence

$$\mathcal{O}_{C^-}(3b_i(p_0 - p_i)) \simeq \mathcal{O}_{C^-}.$$

Thus, we have $b_i \rightarrow +\infty$ as $i \rightarrow +\infty$. Therefore, $H_i^2 \rightarrow +\infty$ as $i \rightarrow +\infty$. $\square$

Remark 4.20. If we choose $p_i \in C^- \subset W$ such that the divisor $p_i - p_0 \in \text{Pic}^0(C^-)$ is non-torsion, then X_i is not projective. Indeed, if X_i is projective, then there exists a very ample divisor H_i on X_i . Hence, by the proof of Theorem 4.19, we have $\mathcal{O}_{C^-}(3b_i(p_0 - p_i)) \simeq \mathcal{O}_{C^-}$. It follows that $p_i - p_0 \in \text{Pic}(C^-)$ is torsion, which leads to a contradiction.

Proof of Theorem 1.2. It follows from Theorem 4.5, Theorem 4.9, Theorem 4.14 and Theorem 4.19 $\square$

REFERENCES

- [ABB⁺23] Kenneth Ascher, Dori Bejleri, Harold Blum, Kristin DeVleming, Giovanni Inchiostro, Yuchen Liu, and Xiaowei Wang. Moduli of boundary polarized Calabi-Yau pairs, 2023. [arXiv:2307.06522](#). 15
- [Ale94] Valery Alexeev. Boundedness and K^2 for log surfaces. *Internat. J. Math.*, 5(6):779–810, 1994. 22, 23
- [Art70] M. Artin. Algebraization of formal moduli. II. Existence of modifications. *Ann. of Math. (2)*, 91:88–135, 1970. 6, 12
- [BdFFU15] S. Boucksom, T. de Fernex, C. Favre, and S. Urbinati. Valuation spaces and multiplier ideals on singular varieties. In *Recent Advances in Algebraic Geometry: A Volume in Honor of Rob*

- Lazarsfeld's 60th Birthday*, London Mathematical Society Lecture Note Series, pages 29–51. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2015. [8](#)
- [BH22] Caucher Birkar and Christopher D. Hacon. Variations of generalised pairs, 2022. [arXiv:2204.10456](#). [2](#), [3](#), [15](#)
- [Bia89] Aldo Biancofiore. On the Hyperplane Sections of Blow-Ups of Complex Projective Plane. *Canad. J. Math.*, 41(6):1005–1020, 1989. [4](#)
- [Bia90] Aldo Biancofiore. On the hyperplane sections of ruled surfaces. In *Algebraic Geometry (L'Aquila, 1988)*, volume 1417 of *Lecture Notes in Math.*, pages 52–66. Springer, Berlin, 1990. [5](#)
- [Bir21a] Caucher Birkar. Boundedness and volume of generalised pairs, 2021. [arXiv:2103.14935](#). [2](#), [6](#), [7](#)
- [Bir21b] Caucher Birkar. Generalised pairs in birational geometry. *EMS Surv. Math. Sci.*, 8(1-2):5–24, 2021. [3](#)
- [Bir22] Caucher Birkar. Moduli of algebraic varieties, 2022. [arXiv:2211.11237](#). [2](#), [17](#)
- [Bir23] Caucher Birkar. Geometry of polarised varieties. *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.*, 137:47–105, 2023. [14](#)
- [Bir24] Caucher Birkar. Boundedness of Fano type fibrations. *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Supér. (4)*, 57(3):787–840, 2024. [21](#)
- [BL24] Harold Blum and Yuchen Liu. Good moduli spaces for boundary polarized Calabi-Yau surface pairs, 2024. [arXiv:2407.00850](#). [15](#)
- [Fil18] Stefano Filipazzi. Boundedness of log canonical surface generalized polarized pairs. *Taiwanese J. Math.*, 22(4):813–850, 2018. [2](#), [4](#), [7](#), [8](#)
- [Fuj09] Osamu Fujino. Effective base point free theorem for log canonical pairs—Kollár type theorem. *Tohoku Math. J. (2)*, 61(4):475–481, 2009. [8](#), [11](#), [15](#), [23](#)
- [Fuj12] Osamu Fujino. Minimal model theory for log surfaces. *Publ. Res. Inst. Math. Sci.*, 48(2):339–371, 2012. [4](#)
- [Fuj17] Osamu Fujino. Effective basepoint-free theorem for semi-log canonical surfaces. *Publ. Res. Inst. Math. Sci.*, 53(3):349–370, 2017. [8](#), [11](#), [15](#), [23](#)
- [Gra62] Hans Grauert. Über Modifikationen und exzeptionelle analytische Mengen. *Math. Ann.*, 146:331–368, 1962. [12](#)
- [Han17] Krishna Hanumanthu. Positivity of line bundles on special blow ups of $\mathbb{P}^2$. *J. Pure Appl. Algebra*, 221(9):2372–2382, 2017. [5](#)
- [Har77] Robin Hartshorne. *Algebraic Geometry*, volume No. 52 of *Graduate Texts in Mathematics*. Springer-Verlag, New York-Heidelberg, 1977. [21](#), [22](#)
- [HMX13] Christopher D. Hacon, James McKernan, and Chenyang Xu. On the birational automorphisms of varieties of general type. *Ann. of Math. (2)*, 177(3):1077–1111, 2013. [2](#)
- [HMX14] Christopher D. Hacon, James McKernan, and Chenyang Xu. ACC for log canonical thresholds. *Ann. of Math. (2)*, 180(2):523–571, 2014. [2](#)
- [HMX18] Christopher D. Hacon, James McKernan, and Chenyang Xu. Boundedness of moduli of varieties of general type. *J. Eur. Math. Soc. (JEMS)*, 20(4):865–901, 2018. [2](#), [7](#)
- [Jia23] Xiaowei Jiang. Boundedness of klt good minimal models, 2023. [arXiv:2312.03313](#). [2](#), [17](#)
- [Jia25] Junpeng Jiao. Boundedness of polarized log Calabi-Yau fibrations. *Journal of Differential Geometry*, 130(3):635–675, 2025. [2](#)
- [JJZ25] Xiaowei Jiang, Junpeng Jiao, and Minzhe Zhu. Boundedness of polarized log Calabi-Yau fibrations with bounded bases, 2025. To appear in J. Eur. Math. Soc. [arXiv:2504.05243](#). [2](#)

- [JL21] Chen Jiang and Haidong Liu. Boundedness of log pluricanonical representations of log Calabi-Yau pairs in dimension 2. *Algebra Number Theory*, 15(2):545–567, 2021. [15](#)
- [KM98] János Kollár and Shigefumi Mori. *Birational Geometry of Algebraic Varieties*, volume 134 of *Cambridge Tracts in Mathematics*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1998. [4](#), [8](#), [16](#)
- [Kol07] János Kollár. *Lectures on Resolution of Singularities*, volume 166 of *Annals of Mathematics Studies*. Princeton University Press, Princeton, NJ, 2007. [21](#), [23](#)
- [Kol21] János Kollár. Deformations of varieties of general type. *Milan J. Math.*, 89(2):345–354, 2021. [18](#)
- [Kol22] János Kollár. Seshadri’s criterion and openness of projectivity. *Proc Math Sci*, 132(2):40, 2022. [13](#)
- [Kol23] János Kollár. *Families of Varieties of General Type*, volume 231 of *Cambridge Tracts in Mathematics*. Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2023. [2](#)
- [Nug24] Brian Nugent. Moduli of Very Ample Line Bundles, 2024. [arXiv:2405.17689](#). [14](#)
- [Sak85] Fumio Sakai. The structure of normal surfaces. *Duke Math. J.*, 52(3):627–648, 1985. [8](#)
- [Zhu25] Minzhe Zhu. Boundedness of Stable Minimal Models With KLT Singularities. *Int. Math. Res. Not.*, 2025(2):rne293, 2025. [2](#)

DEPARTMENT OF MATHEMATICS, UNIVERSITY OF UTAH, 155 S 1400 E, SALT LAKE CITY, UTAH, 84112, USA

Email address: `hacon@math.utah.edu`

SHANGHAI CENTER FOR MATHEMATICAL SCIENCES, FUDAN UNIVERSITY, SHANGHAI 200438, CHINA

Email address: `xw_jiang@fudan.edu.cn`